

2024 JavaScript Rising Stars: Top Projects and Ecosystem Shifts

GitHub stars added in 2024 from Best of JS curated projects

9th edition of JavaScript Rising Stars

Methodology: ranking by stars gained during calendar year 2024

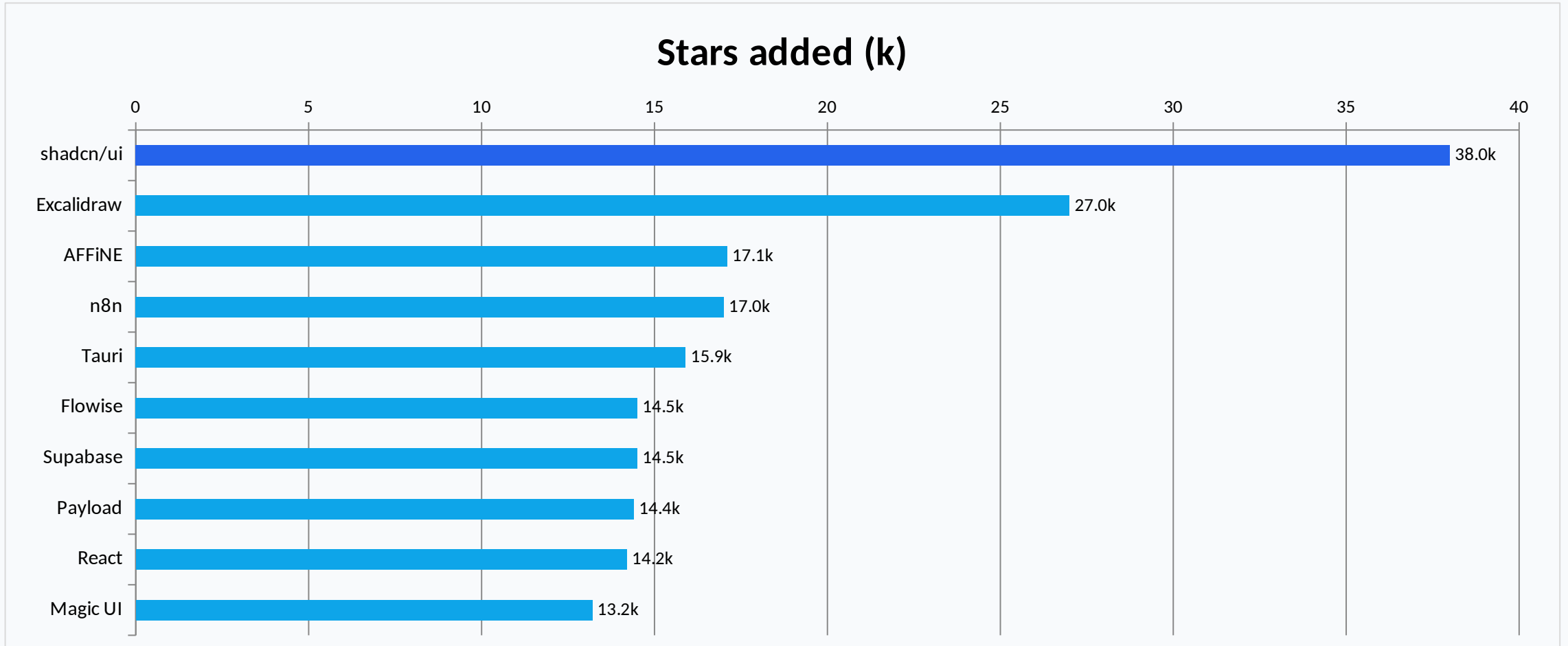
Data scope: Best of JS curated ecosystem projects

Audience: frontend engineers and engineering managers

Goal: identify traction signals and 2025 planning implications

Overall Top 10 in 2024

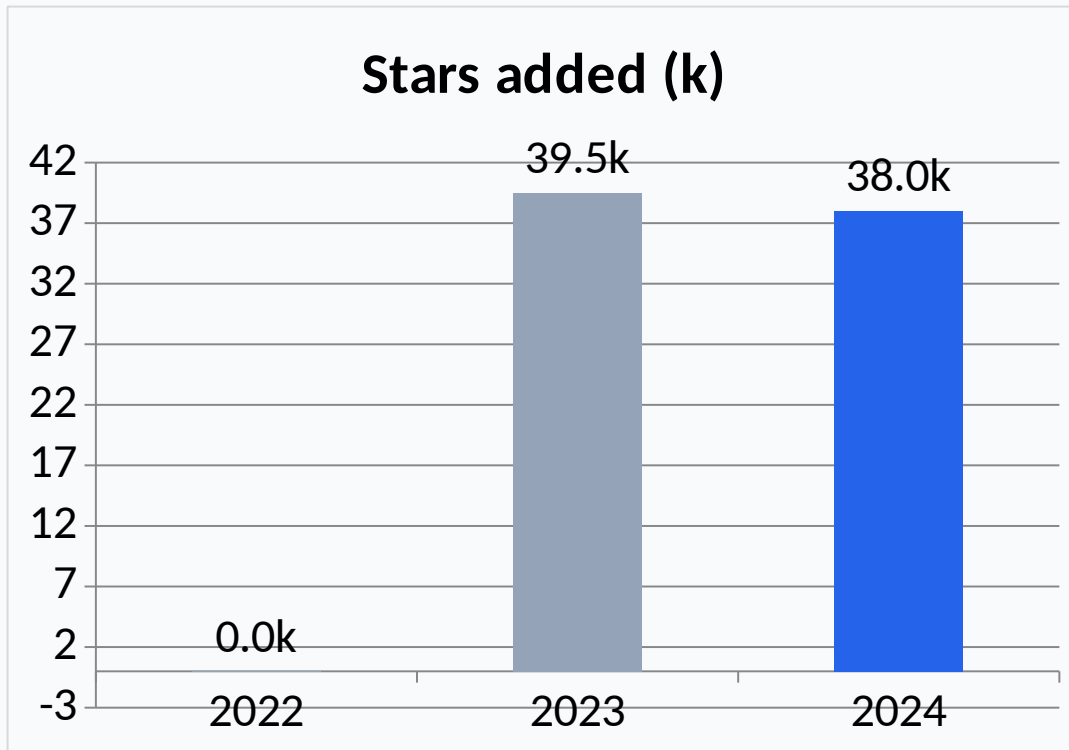
shadcn/ui creates a clear #1 gap at +38.0k stars



#1 exceeds #2 by +11.0k and #10 by +24.8k stars

shadcn/ui Deep Dive

Second consecutive year at #1 with sustained acceleration



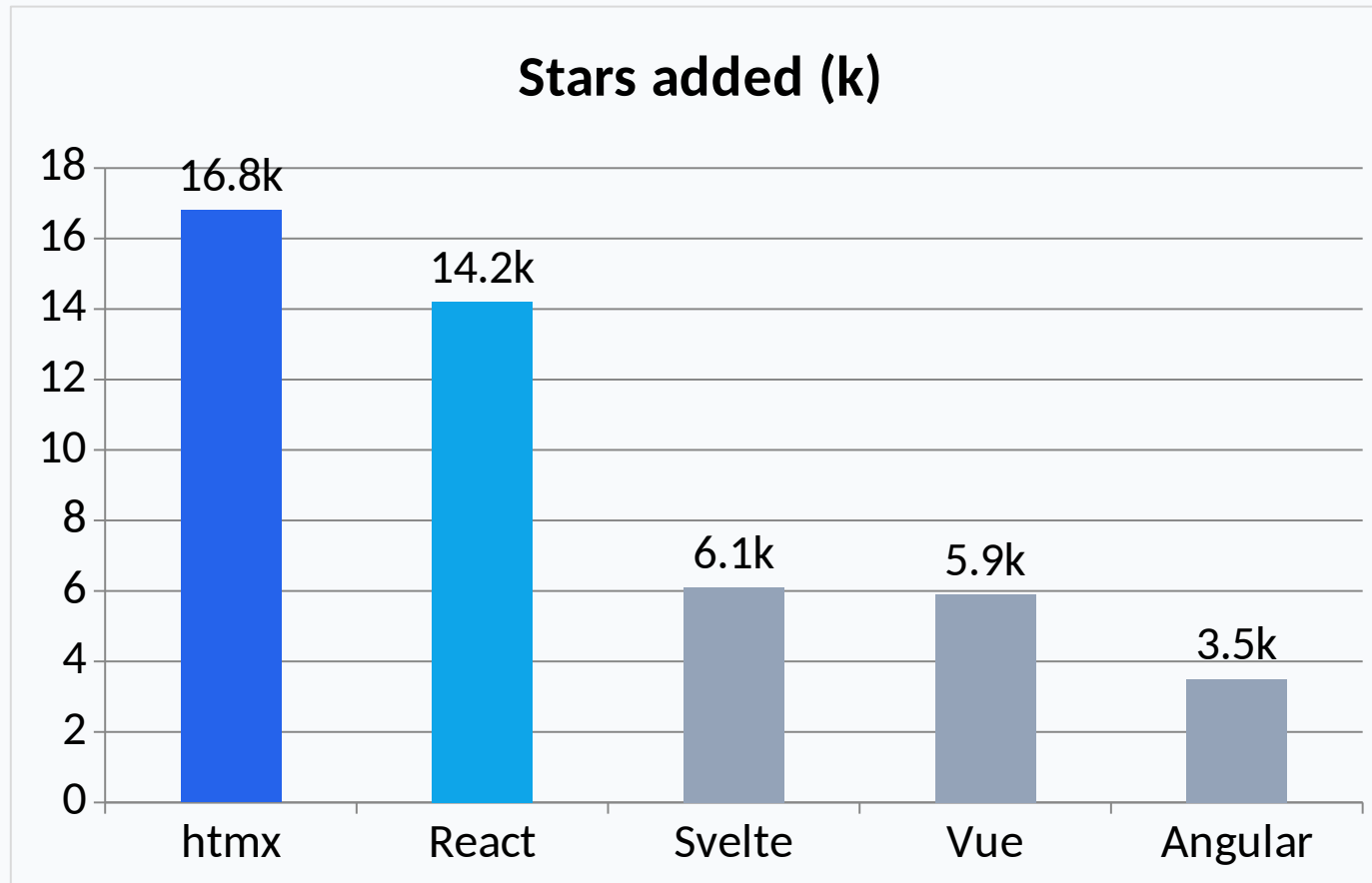
2024 features shipped:

- Charts
- Themes
- Blocks
- Sidebar
- New CLI with multi-framework support

Total stars reached: 77.5k

Front-end Frameworks Shakeup

htmx overtakes React in 2024 stars added

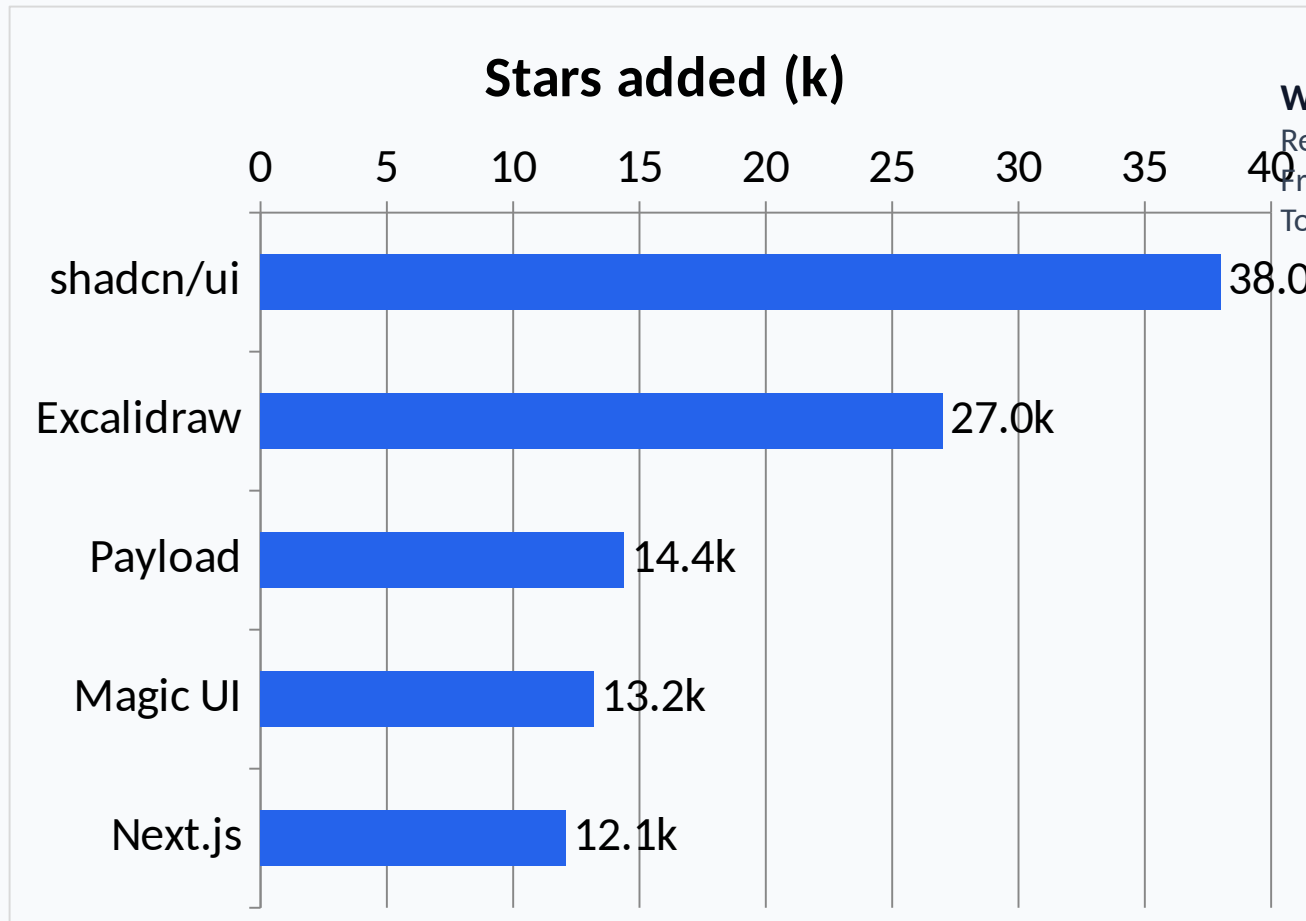


Interpretation

- htmx: HTML-extension model gains mainstream traction
- React 19 released after long wait
- Server Components + Server Functions signal architectural shift
- Smaller frameworks continue steady growth

React Ecosystem Top 5

shadcn/ui, Excalidraw, and Payload lead project momentum

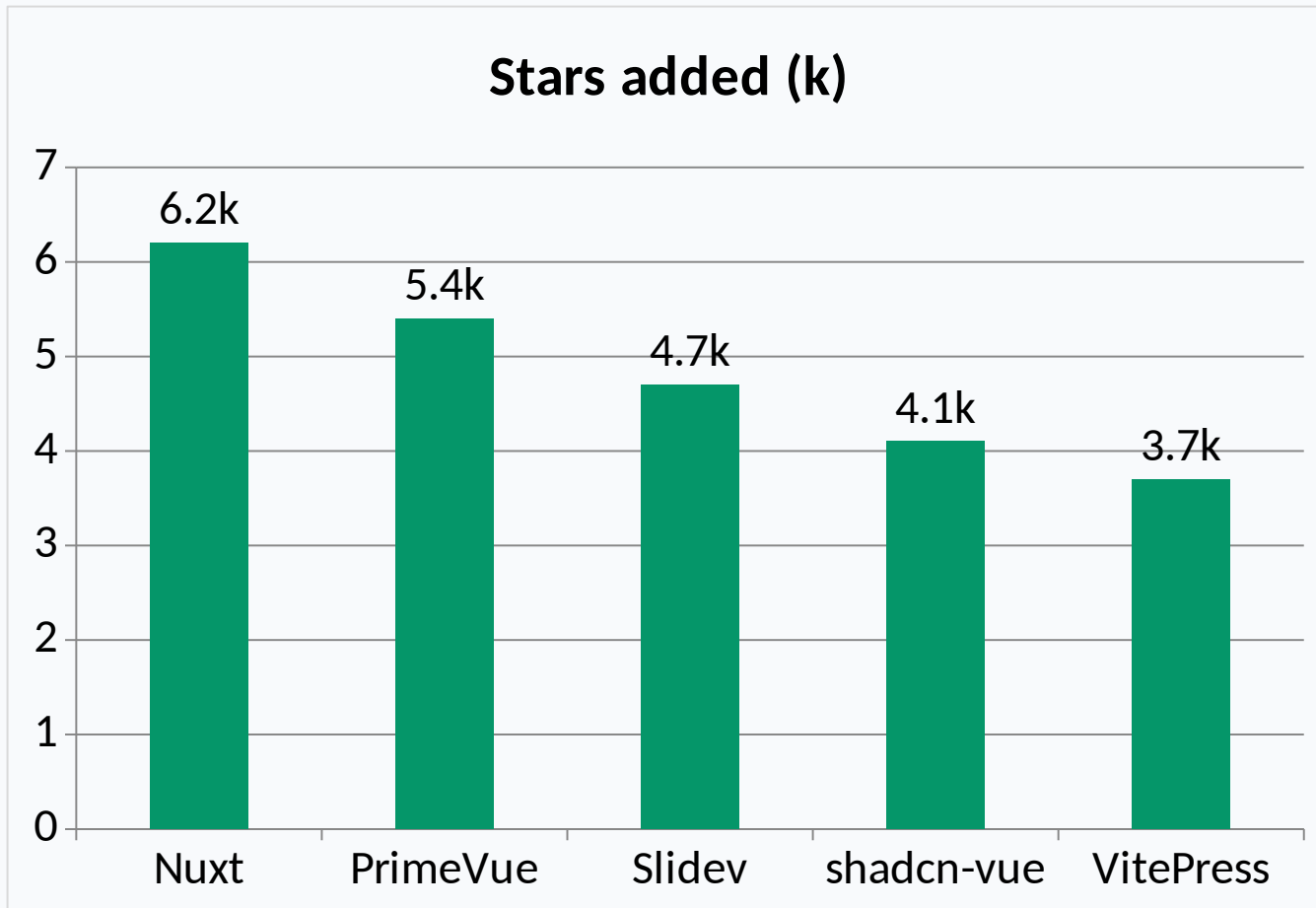


Why it matters

React increasingly behaves like a framework specification, not only a UI library.
Frameworks interpret React primitives differently (e.g., server-first conventions).
Tooling and component ecosystems are now primary differentiators.

Vue Ecosystem Top 5

Nuxt and UI libraries highlight ecosystem maturity



Signals

Vue 3.5 reworked reactivity internals.

alien-signals approach already landed in main branch.

UI-library growth (PrimeVue, shadcn-vue) indicates confidence.

Nuxt keeps strong release cadence and performance focus.

Emerging Themes Across the Ecosystem

AI tools, desktop apps, and browser-native capabilities

AI-First Tooling

n8n +17.0k
Flowise +14.5k
Supabase +14.5k
AFFiNE +17.1k

Desktop via Web Tech

Tauri +15.9k
Lighter desktop/mobile app path with web stacks

Browser Innovation

PGlite: Postgres in WebAssembly
WebVM: VM fully in browser

Key Takeaways for 2025 Planning

Actionable signals from 2024 JavaScript momentum

- Component ownership wins: shadcn/ui validates copy-and-own over package imports.
- HTML-first is mainstream: htmx outpaced React in stars added (+16.8k vs +14.2k).
- React is a platform spec: server primitives shift value to framework implementations.
- AI integration is table stakes: multiple top projects embed AI workflows deeply.
- Vue maturity is accelerating: stronger UI ecosystem and core reactivity evolution.

Use these trends to prioritize architecture, tooling, and team skill investments for 2025.